HONG (IVY) ZHAN

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Website | GitHub | LinkedIn

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Trust in generative AI, cross-platform information evaluation, and participation in online communities, using computational and qualitative methods.

EDUCATION

University of York, York, UK 2022 – 2024
MSc in Social Media and Management, with Merit
Selected coursework: Research Design; Understanding Social Media; Social Media, Data & Society.

Wuchang University of Technology, Wuhan, China 2017 – 2021
BEng in Computer Science and Technology
Selected coursework: Probability and Mathematical Statistics; Data Structures; Software Modeling; Software Testing.

MANUSCRIPTS

Zhan, H. (2026). Beyond the Aggregate: Trust and Distrust in Generative AI Across Technical Reddit Communities and Time. *Under review at Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW).* Sole author.
Preprint: SSRN | Data & code: Zenodo · GitHub

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Generative AI Trust and Distrust in Technical Reddit Communities
Sole-author research Feb 2026 – Oct 2026

- Found close pooled shares of *Neither* (neither trust nor distrust; 41.7%) and *Trust* (40.0%), with different community orderings: Trust led in r/ChatGPTCoding and r/programming; Neither led in r/webdev, r/GitHub, and r/compsci.
- Designed a secondary analysis of released data from five technical Reddit communities, analyzing 8,519 classification records and 4,964 dimension records separately by community and half-year in Python and R.
- Documented data sources, missing labels, and sparse periods; distinguished the substitute dimension analysis from replication of the source study.

Cross-Platform Social Media Use and Information Practices
MSc dissertation research | University of York Feb 2023 – Sep 2023

- Designed and conducted 15 semi-structured interviews (approximately 60 minutes each) on cross-platform social media use and cultural adaptation among Chinese students in the UK.
- Transcribed interviews and coded them thematically in NVivo; analyzed social media posts. Identified platform-specific communication, language barriers, and cross-platform credibility checking.

Recruitment Management System
BEng Graduation Thesis (Design) | Wuchang University of Technology Feb 2021 – Jun 2021

- Translated recruitment workflow requirements into interaction flows and prototypes; implemented job posting, application tracking, and candidate management using Spring Boot and MySQL.
- Evaluated recruitment workflows through think-aloud usability testing with 8 participants; used findings to guide interface revisions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Strategy Analyst | TikTok Shop, London, UK Sep 2024 – Jan 2026

- Analyzed UK e-commerce performance across merchant growth, product operations, and content-driven sales; monitored KPIs and investigated performance trends.
- Supported cross-functional strategic initiatives, business reviews, and operational improvements through analysis of merchant and product performance.

Founder & Operations Manager | Zero Point HR, Wuhan, China Oct 2017 – Sep 2022

- Built a recruitment operations platform coordinating approximately 30 staff and matching job seekers with employers.
- Designed candidate-screening, shift-scheduling, and placement-tracking workflows supporting 3,000+ full-time placements and 100,000+ part-time shifts.

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

Tech Volunteer | BetaNYC, New York, USA Jan 2026 – Mar 2026

- Prepared NYC public datasets and accessible visualizations for open-data and civic-tech workshops; engaged residents on barriers to accessing government information.

Data Volunteer | DataKind, London, UK Dec 2023 – Jul 2024

- Cleaned and analyzed nonprofit service data with Python/pandas in a DataDive; produced visualizations and a stakeholder briefing to inform program decisions.

International Student Buddy | University of York, York, UK Oct 2022 – Sep 2023

- Mentored international students transitioning to university life, providing practical guidance and connecting them with campus resources and student communities.

RESEARCH METHODS & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Methods: Research design; semi-structured interviews; thematic analysis; think-aloud usability testing; descriptive statistics; data validation, provenance, and reproducibility.

Programming & analysis: Python (pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib), R, SQL, NVivo.

Design & systems: Requirements analysis, interaction design, Figma, web development, Spring Boot, MySQL.

Research workflow: Git/GitHub, LaTeX.

LANGUAGES

English (fluent); Chinese (native).

ACADEMIC REFERENCES

Prof. David Beer, Department of Sociology, University of York, Webpage.
Dr Bob Townley, School for Business and Society, University of York, Webpage.
James Lamont, FHEA, Department of Education, University of York, Webpage.